

IMAGE COURTESY **SKYROOT AEROSPACE**

INDIA'S SPACE ECONOMY

$8.4 BN
IN 2022

$44 BN
BY 2033

GLOBAL SPACE ECONOMY

$630 BN
IN 2023

$1.8 TRN
BY 2035

NOTE INDIA ESTIMATES ARE IN-SPACE PROJECTIONS
SOURCE WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM-MCKINSEY REPORT

a consortium led by Pixxel and including Dhruva Space, PierSight and SatSure, for the country's first indigenous, fully commercial Earth-observation constellation under the public-private partnership framework. The consortium will build, own and operate 12 satellites, investing more than ₹1,200 crore, with the network scheduled to be operational by 2029.

These are still early days, but the direction is clear. SpaceX has already shown how government contracts can help a space company build the capabilities and scale to become a commercial business. It is SpaceX that these founders most want to emulate, which, ironically, is also their biggest competitor globally.

THE (SPACE)X FACTOR

When Bellatrix's founders were starting out, they considered building launch vehicles themselves. Then SpaceX demonstrated reusability—the first Falcon 9 booster landing in 2015, the first reflight in 2017—and the economics of the industry shifted overnight.